

Chapter 130_1 - Fulfillment

Boundless catastrophe was coming—almost everyone said so. The common people of the four realms despaired, able only to place their last hope in the surviving immortal sects, hoping they could destroy that Heaven-Defying Divine Demon¹ who brought disaster to the world.

However, in just a hundred short years, the immortal sects had fought several life-and-death battles with the Heaven-Defying Divine Demon. Those of the immortal sects died and were wounded, their strength greatly diminished, while that demon lord's demonic energy became increasingly rampant. A mere gesture brought carnage to living beings—terrifying to the point of being outrageous.

The human realm also frequently spawned evil spirits and malicious ghosts. Natural disasters struck repeatedly, leaving countless families broken and people in unbearable pain.

Thus, the people blamed all these calamities on the demon lord. For a time, wailing spread everywhere as tens of thousands of mortals burned incense and prayed to gods, beseeching heavenly deities to descend and destroy the demons, returning peace to the world.

The remaining few sect masters of the immortal gates first sought help from Penglai². Though they didn't meet the secluded Emperor Tianrui³, they ultimately borrowed some troops. At the same time, they widely recruited strange talents and hermit immortals from across the land to join them in attacking the demon realm and fighting that demon lord to the death.

That battle could truly be called one of corpses strewn everywhere and blood flowing like rivers. Even the Western Wasteland desert was soaked with blood, littered with bodies of both demon clan and immortal realm people. Finally, they were all burned in a great fire, leaving only choking thick smoke rolling skyward, connecting with the gloom overhead.

And that notorious demon lord stood suspended above the smoke and clouds, magnificent robes of red and white fluttering. Only contempt for all living beings and killing intent filled her eyes. She threw back her head and laughed heartily, bringing down hundreds of heavenly thunderbolts that struck until even the fierce winds wailed.

All who survived that day were filled with terror, describing it with one word:

"Madman!" they said in fear.

"That's no longer human—just a madman!"

After the battle ended, the bloody smell drifted for a hundred li and didn't dissipate for days.

The Demon Cave was also silent and oppressive. Though the demon realm folk felt exhilarated, no one dared to provoke the unpredictable Demon Lord, especially after that elven beauty had perished.

Working before the Demon Lord meant risking decapitation for even the slightest mistake. Moreover, the Demon Lord herself didn't like being disturbed, so the entire Demon Cave was guarded by very few people.

The dripping sound continued incessantly. Ning Fuyi frowned for a moment before opening her eyes. In the haze, water drops fell on her brow, ice-cold.

The pillow was also wet—whether from tears or the dripping water, she couldn't tell.

Ning Fuyi wiped her eyes and got up, staggering two steps before fully awakening.

These past few days she had been constantly drowsy, often unaware of the time for half the day, her mind chaotic and complex, yet irritated and hard to bear.

Water was dripping not only from above but also pooling coldly at her feet. Ning Fuyi walked out of the bedchamber in full fury, following stone steps upward, and kicked open a heavy iron door.

Water that had been trickling like a fine stream now gushed out with a splash. Ning Fuyi dodged to the doorway but still got her waist chain wet, so she darkened her face, brushed away the moisture, and waded through the water with large strides.

"Divine Venerable Chu Ling, how truly cunning you are," she sneered with curled lips, then waved her hand to absorb the flowing water and strode to the source of the trouble.

The woman's hands and feet were tightly bound to an iron frame, restrained by her own Flying Feather Rope⁴. The white rope bound her wrists, tying them until they were red.

She bore no wounds, only disheveled hair and blood at the corners of her mouth. Her entire being emanated an air of decay, yet her eyes were bright, staring directly at Ning Fuyi.

"Stop looking at me like that!" Ning Fuyi suddenly roared, dark mist surging from her palms, instantly blasting a hole in the stone slabs at her feet.

Stone fragments scattered in all directions, some cutting Chu Qingqiu's face. A spot of red on her lotus-like face was particularly striking.

She immediately turned her head away without making a sound.

"Chu Qingqiu, I already spared you, but you came knocking on my door yourself, walking into my trap, asking for suffering!" Ning Fuyi stepped before her, the sharp Emei Thorn⁵ sliding across the woman's throat, causing her to tremble slightly.

"Afraid?" Ning Fuyi giggled. She released the Emei Thorn and used her fingertips to caress Chu Qingqiu's sweat-dampened neck, causing the woman to struggle more violently.

"Don't move," Ning Fuyi said softly. She suddenly drew close to the woman to smell the gardenia fragrance on her body. "How disgusting."

"I've always hated gardenias most in my life—born in mud yet pretending to be unstained, with a pungent smell, just like your heart: pretending to be noble but actually filthy and corrupt." As Ning Fuyi spoke, her expression became increasingly crazed.

"Someone come, fetch a bucket of water—natural flower dew, the purest and cleanest kind," she staggered backward, giving orders in a low voice.

A small demon child who came at her call hurriedly pattered away. In less than an incense stick's time, he returned carrying a huge wooden bucket, timidly offering it to Ning Fuyi.

"What are you going to do?" Chu Qingqiu stared at the bucket in her hands, seemingly wanting to avoid it but fixed in place by the Flying Feather Rope.

As soon as she spoke, the water splashed over her from head to toe. Chu Qingqiu bit her teeth tightly and closed her eyes, allowing herself to be thoroughly soaked. Her hair was completely wet and stuck to her chest, her eyelashes dripping continuously, making it difficult to open her eyes.

"Don't you love using water? It's perfect for washing away the smell on you, so this lord can feel less nauseated," Ning Fuyi said with sorrow in her eyes but a constant smile on her lips. She stepped forward again to lift the woman's hair and carefully examine her face.

"Ning Fuyi, you're not bad by nature—it's just the demonic energy causing trouble. Don't persist in your delusion..." Chu Qingqiu said in a low voice, her voice trembling.

"I'm not bad?" Ning Fuyi seemed to have heard the greatest joke and laughed heartily, her lips red as blood. "Stop trying to save face. Didn't you already determine I was that evil spawn bringing disaster to all living beings? Didn't you already want to kill me?"

"Come, I'll give you this chance." As she spoke, she untied the Flying Feather Rope from Chu Qingqiu's body, drew a gleaming precious sword from a nearby weapon rack, and forcibly stuffed it into Chu Qingqiu's powerless hands, commanding her to grip it.

Then she slowly retreated, spreading her arms wide. Her long robes with golden silk embroidery dragged down as she swayed and steadied herself: "Come on, don't disappoint all the common people under heaven."

Chu Qingqiu could barely hold the sword. She was easily led by Ning Fuyi's emotions, forced into panic and unable to control herself.

"No..." she shook her head. "I promised your mother I wouldn't kill you."

"Won't kill me? When the six realms are destroyed, you'll also be that executioner." Ning Fuyi let her arms drop as if she had expected this. "Do you know how cruel it would be for the six realms to be destroyed by my hand? I'll give you another chance—will you kill me or not?"

Chu Qingqiu still shook her head.

Ning Fuyi hated most this eternally indifferent expression of hers. She just wanted to see what she looked like with the seven emotions and six desires⁶: "It seems I need to show you something..."

She reached behind her and pulled out a long black wooden box, looking up as if recalling: "Do you still remember your little disciple?"

Chu Qingqiu trembled.

"I remember she always followed you around before, also looking down on me with arrogance and condescension." Ning Fuyi said gently. "She said she hated the demon clan, and since I was willing to become a demon, she pursued me for thousands of li, wanting to kill me and save the world."

"How overconfident. I had already spared her life, but she insisted on killing me. What choice did I have?" Ning Fuyi spoke as if whispering, watching with satisfaction as Chu Qingqiu lost her last trace of color, the blood seeping into her eyes.

"What did you do to her..." Chu Qingqiu nearly crushed the jade-carved sword hilt, murmuring.

"Here, see for yourself." Ning Fuyi stuffed the wooden box into her arms.

The box opened to reveal two curved swords stained with mud and blood, stacked inside. Blood still flowed down the hilts, hot bloody stench hitting her face.

"Ning Fuyi, you're a demon..." Chu Qingqiu dropped the box with a clang. Her already unstable emotions could no longer be hidden as she said sorrowfully and angrily, "You've gone mad!"

"I went mad long ago—you're just realizing it now?" Ning Fuyi grabbed her throat, her voice also carrying a sobbing tone, watching with satisfaction as moisture gathered in Chu Qingqiu's eyes before finally dropping a clear tear.

This was the first time she had seen Chu Qingqiu cry.

"Do you want to kill me now?" Ning Fuyi leaned close to examine her.

Chu Qingqiu could no longer endure it and shouted sternly: "As you wish!"

With that, she slapped Ning Fuyi toward the stone wall with one palm, then raised her sword to stab. Cold light came through the air, and Ning Fuyi was pierced in the flesh as she wished, sweat immediately pouring from her forehead like rain.

The sword tip scraped past half an inch from her heart. The pain made her bend over, but it didn't cause her too much suffering. Instead, she laughed coldly and backhanded the sword into two pieces, pulling out the half stuck in her chest.

The woman before her seemed to have despaired. She continuously shed tears, her body softening as she half-knelt on the ground.

"You still won't kill me." Ning Fuyi shook her head, then suddenly grabbed Chu Qingqiu's collar and forcefully lifted her up.

The woman's body was much thinner than she remembered. This vague thought flashed through Ning Fuyi's mind, then she mocked herself—back then she was young and weak, seeing her as impossibly tall and mighty.

Now that she possessed boundless demonic power, she naturally no longer thought so.

She dragged the person to a corner, then pushed forward. After Chu Qingqiu staggered to steady herself, she waved her hand to form hand seals, then sent them into the ground with fierce wind. The surroundings suddenly lit up.

An enormous formation drawn in fresh blood appeared before them, every line traced and retraced in blood, shocking enough to make one's heart tremble.

The Reincarnation Array⁷. Chu Qingqiu took a deep breath.

Footnotes:

¹ **Heaven-Defying Divine Demon (诛天神魔)** - A title referring to Ning Fuyi in her demonic form, suggesting one who defies or challenges heaven itself

² **Penglai (蓬莱)** - A legendary immortal realm in Chinese mythology, often depicted as a floating mountain or island paradise

³ **Emperor Tianrui (天瑞帝君)** - A high-ranking celestial ruler, whose name suggests "Heavenly Auspicious Emperor"

⁴ **Flying Feather Rope (飞羽索)** - Chu Qingqiu's signature magical binding weapon that can transform into flowing ribbons

⁵ **Emei Thorn (峨眉刺)** - Ning Fuyi's signature weapon, hairpin-like daggers associated with the Emei martial arts school

⁶ **Seven emotions and six desires (七情六欲)** - Traditional Chinese concept referring to the full range of human emotions and desires that immortals typically transcend

⁷ **Reincarnation Array (轮回阵)** - A powerful magical formation related to cycles of rebirth and resurrection